MELATO / DIGITAL FLAGSHIP

The next expression of Melato.

Luxury transition Execution blueprint

One consolidated specification for a white, refined, spacious designer storefront.

DOCUMENT	STATUS
Version 1.1 / October 23, 2026	Revised after peer review; owner authorized decision lock and start of development
Storefront	melato.ca
Repository	github.com/TheHighBrid/Gelato
Scope	10 categories: 9 active; hero refinement deferred
Next gate	Phase 4: live-source reconciliation, foundation activation and validation

Preserve the commerce. Refine the hierarchy. Keep Melato’s dry wit, product evidence, and distinctive palette behavior.

Prepared from the supplied transition research, supporting brand documents, and read-only GitHub inspection. This is the locked design plan. Initial execution status is recorded in the W0/W1 appendix. It is not a deployment or release approval.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

01 / Mandate and phase boundaries

Transition Melato from an OLED-dark, visually dense storefront to a clean white designer-house presentation. Use Casablanca, Gucci, Dior, and Louis Vuitton as directional references for composure, imagery, hierarchy, and service. Preserve Melato’s identity and current core shopping behavior.

PHASE	DELIVERABLE / EXIT CONDITION
1. Research / complete per owner	The supplied research is the input corpus. Phase 2 consolidates it rather than starting another market study.
2. Consolidation / this PDF	One coherent specification: ten categories, decisions, source traceability, implementation sequence, validation and release gates.
3. Automated peer review / next	Review this specification; resolve blocking findings. Owner supplies the finalized documentation. No branch implementation starts before that handoff.
4. Development / future	Implement finalized scope on feat/melato-luxury-transition, branched from the verified current main. Validate on an unpublished theme. No direct commits to main.
5. Integration / future	After validation and owner release authorization, merge the reviewed PR and publish the exact verified Shopify theme candidate. Retain rollback.

Included

White surfaces; two-family typography; expanded spacing; media presentation; navigation and footer styling; collection cards; PDP hierarchy and disclosures; restrained interaction; shopping bag and existing client-service presentation.

Excluded

Hero creative redesign; replatforming or headless migration; product renaming; price or inventory changes; new backorders, gifting, express-delivery thresholds, concierge channels, or custom search infrastructure. Existing behavior stays available. Remediation that changes a canonical Bible rule requires its own owner-reviewed version change.

Basis: Owner brief; R1-R7; G1-G3. Category 04 counts within ten but has compatibility work only.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

02 / Source hierarchy and consolidation

The owner’s current scope controls the project. Product semantics follow the repository’s mandatory Bible and JSON contract. Research provides design evidence and proposals, not authority to overwrite product rules.

ID	SUPPLIED PRIMARY DOCUMENT	ROLE IN THIS PLAN
R1	Argon (1).PDF / 15 pages	Detailed tokens, media, navigation, buy-box and disclosure proposals.
R2	Argon (2).pdf / 34 pages	Mobile ergonomics, icon consistency, staged implementation and technical safeguards.
R3	Argon (3).PDF / 11 pages	Spatial composition, media, motion and branch/CI concepts.
R4	Argon (4).md	Detailed file and category matrix; overlaps R1. Treated as corroborating detail, not independent validation.
R5	Argon (5).pdf / 22 pages	PLP, PDP, bag and service proposals; performance and accessibility conflicts resolved here.
R6	PERPLE(1).pdf / 24 pages	Two-family typography, governance, narrative context and preservation principles.
R7	SOL (0).pdf / 74 pages	Broad ten-category structure, motion, service and non-regression review rubric.

Canonical and historical references

G1: AGENTS.md and AI_OPERATOR_GOVERNANCE.md. G2: docs/MELATO_PRODUCT_PAGE_BIBLE.md v1.0.0. G3: config/melato-product-page-bible.json v1.0.0. S1: attached Product Page Bible PDF. S2: attached Product Naming Style PDF. S3: September Premium House blueprint. S4: Website Studio reference package. Older documents are context; their data and code are not deployment candidates.

Archive triage: seven primary research files; repeated Website Studio packages; legacy theme archives, guides and a 778-page historical research compilation. Historical material was selectively consulted, not treated as a current storefront audit. Low-text/scanned ancillary files were not used as factual evidence.

Basis: Supplied archive and local PDFs; GitHub sources read October 22, 2026. Full source index on page 24.

RESEARCH / CONSOLIDATED DESIGN DIRECTION

03 / Benchmark principles / Melato adaptation

The supplied research agrees on the broad direction while disagreeing on exact fonts, hex values, layouts and feature scope. The useful output is a set of design principles translated into Melato requirements. The descriptions below summarize the research, not a fresh audit of the four live websites.

REFERENCE HOUSE	PRINCIPLE REPORTED IN RESEARCH	MELATO ADAPTATION
Casablanca	Expressive fashion and editorial imagery presented within a quiet, light commerce frame.	Keep Melato color and wit in garments and imagery. Let the shell recede; preserve practical sizing and product discovery. C01, C05, C07, C08.
Gucci	Strong house identity, structured product information and visible service pathways coexist with expressive campaigns.	Retain Melato names and product evidence. Clarify technical sections and existing support; avoid adding unsupported backorder or luxury service promises. C06, C08, C10.
Dior	Controlled typographic hierarchy, generous space, craft narrative and calm presentation.	Use regular-weight editorial typography, measured whitespace and verified construction content. Do not import proprietary fonts or replace concise Story copy with long heritage prose. C02, C03, C08.
Louis Vuitton	Product-led gallery scale, restrained interface framing and orderly purchase/service journeys.	Present truthful separate views at larger scale; align controls and bag styling; preserve function and safe product accents. C01, C05, C09, C10.

Shared direction

Remove competing decorative emphasis. Give each page one clear primary focus, with the product and purchase path carrying the visual hierarchy. Use photography, material evidence and an intentional rhythm to express quality; typography and blank space alone cannot establish craftsmanship.

Evidence discipline

Exact benchmark-house font identifications, copied design-system values and commercial improvement percentages are not accepted as verified facts. Some research cites unofficial recreations and third-party case studies. This blueprint uses them for direction only and labels Melato token choices as proposed design decisions. No sales lift, conversion lift or ranking gain is promised.

Basis: R1-R7 competitive matrices and narrative. S2 preserves Melato naming; S3 supports designer-house positioning without a rebuild.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

04 / Decisions that remove contradictions

RESEARCH CONFLICT	CONSOLIDATED DECISION
Three active foundations vs ten categories	C01-C03 active foundations; C04 deferred hero; C05-C10 six active enhancements. Accessibility/performance are cross-cutting gates, not an eleventh category.
Competing typefaces; third mono family	Cormorant Garamond 400 editorial + Plus Jakarta Sans 400/500 commerce. Two production families. No added mono download. Font licensing and glyph coverage verified in Phase 4.
Long stories; new seven-layer rules	Keep canonical Story at 35-80 words, up to 110 only with owner approval. Preserve G3's thirteen logical PDP positions and category matrix.
Rename merchandising sections	Keep Complete the Set, You might also like, and Recently viewed. No Curated Selection or Recently Inspected replacements.
Multi-panel media; rigid image crops	One image per file; no collage, diptych or multi-panel composition. Use separate gallery assets. Product-only imagery uses contain; editorial crops must preserve garment detail.
Backorders, gifting, WhatsApp, shipping thresholds	Preserve existing working features; do not introduce these new workflows or unsupported service claims. No free-shipping progress bar under all-orders complimentary delivery.
Pure monochrome everywhere	White shell with the existing contrast-safe product palette engine retained for announcement, header tint and section titles.
Unverified commercial lift claims	Exclude conversion, sales and engagement lift percentages. Third-party design recreations do not establish official brand fonts, tokens or causal performance outcomes.
44/48px described as WCAG AA floor	Melato chooses >=44px targets, 48px for size cells; WCAG 2.2 AA SC 2.5.8 uses 24px with exceptions. Text-spacing values are override tests, not compulsory default styling.

Basis: Conflicts in R1-R7 resolved against owner scope and G1-G3; W1-W2 verify accessibility interpretations.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

05 / The ten-category master plan

ID / STATE	CATEGORY	REQUIRED RESULT
C01 / active	White canvas	White page shell, warm neutral media wells, near-black ink; preserve product accents.
C02 / active	Refined typography	Two purposeful families, regular weights, readable body copy and calm commerce labels.
C03 / active	Whitespace and rhythm	Consistent responsive gutters and section spacing; uncluttered control groups.
C04 / deferred	Hero optimization	Existing media, text, links and playback behavior preserved; compatibility isolation only.
C05 / active	Editorial media	Consistent containers, truthful product views, responsive delivery and functioning zoom.
C06 / active	Navigation and footer	Quieter framing; all navigation, search, account and policy paths retained.
C07 / active	Collection presentation	Larger clean cards; clear title, price and availability; filters/sort/quick-shop preserved.
C08 / active	Product-detail hierarchy	Editorial presentation of the canonical Bible structure and category disclosures.
C09 / active	Motion and controls	Subtle response, clear focus, coherent icons and complete reduced-motion support.
C10 / active	Service and shopping bag	Calm cart and service presentation using existing channels, policies and capabilities.

How the six research enhancements are consolidated

Media proposals map to C05; header/search/footer to C06; grids/cards to C07; buy-box, story, craft and set modules to C08; microinteraction and mobile control details to C09; bag and clienteling presentation to C10. Editorial storytelling spans C05 and C08. Governance and accessibility apply to all ten.

Numbering follows R7’s broad taxonomy, with R1-R6 details mapped into it. Category IDs remain stable in review findings, tasks and acceptance evidence.

Basis: R1-R7 synthesis. These are Melato design decisions, not copies of any benchmark house’s specification.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

06 / C01: White canvas and safe accents

The default commerce shell is white. Introduce one semantic palette and bridge existing --melato-* and --house-* aliases to it; components must not compete through new global override layers.

ROLE / PROPOSED TOKEN	VALUE	USAGE
--surface-page	#FFFFFF	Body, collection and PDP canvas, bag and search sheets.
--surface-media	#FAF9F6	Product media wells; restrained secondary surfaces.
--surface-subtle	#F3F1EC	Selected neutral states and quiet footer background.
--text-primary	#111111	Product names, copy, prices, navigation.
--text-secondary	#595959	Secondary text; verify on actual composited surface.
--border-subtle	#E6E4E0	Decorative separation only; not sole control boundary.
--border-control	#767676	Control outlines where boundary is needed; verify >=3:1.
--action / --action-text	#111111 / #FFFFFF	Primary purchase and checkout actions.
--error / --success	#8F1010 / #204030	Semantic feedback with text/icon, never color alone.

Product color contract stays intact

Keep custom.background_hex_color_code, foreground_hex_color_code and palette_1/2/3. The background seed continues to drive the announcement bar, not the whole PDP canvas. The same engine supplies a restrained sticky-header tint and safe technical-title accents. Test accent text against white and warm surfaces; require >=4.5:1, then use the explicit safe foreground, then primary ink.

A single selected palette state serves all consumers. Rotation stops under reduced motion. Do not alter canonical fields or create separate per-section engines. Solid white is the fallback for transparency failures; test computed colors after every loaded stylesheet and dynamic update.

Basis: R1/R4 palette; R5 surface roles; R6 governance; G2-G3 color contract. Values above are proposed Melato tokens.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

07 / C02-C03: Type and spatial system

ELEMENT	PROPOSED TYPE / SIZE	LAYOUT RULE
Editorial page title	Cormorant Garamond 400 / 36-56px	Line height 1.1-1.2; preserve accents; hero excluded.
Section heading	Cormorant Garamond 400 / 28-40px	Regular case; avoid repetitive decorative eyebrows.
PDP title	Plus Jakarta Sans 400 / 24-32px	Line height 1.25; natural wrapping, no forced uppercase.
Body / narrative	Plus Jakarta Sans 400 / 16-18px	Line height 1.6-1.75; measure <=62ch.
Product card title / price	Plus Jakarta Sans 400 / 14-16px	Wrap full names; stable spacing without truncating facts.
Navigation / CTA	Plus Jakarta Sans 400-500 / 13-14px	Restrained tracking 0.04-0.10em; no tiny critical labels.

Commerce numbers use the utility sans with lining and tabular numerals for prices, sizes, cart quantities, filter counts and gallery indexes. Editorial serif remains at 28px or larger. Use licensed WOFF2 assets or Shopify-hosted fonts with metric-compatible fallbacks and font-display behavior. Preload only fonts used above the fold. Remove redundant legacy font requests only after confirming every consumer, including the deferred hero. Do not ship proprietary benchmark-house fonts.

SPACING	MOBILE <768px	TABLET 768-1023px	DESKTOP >=1024px
Side gutters	20-24px	32px	clamp(40px, 5.5vw, 96px)
Major section gap	64-80px	80-112px	112-144px
Module gap	40-48px	48-64px	64-80px
Card column gap	12-16px	20-24px	24-32px
PDP column gap	Single column	Single column	48-80px; image-led 60/40

Base spacing scale: 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 80, 112, 144px. Maximum content width 1600px. These are design targets, subject to viewport fit rather than forced overflow. At 320px, prioritize readable controls. Allow 200% zoom and text-spacing overrides without clipping.

Basis: R1-R7 type/space proposals; two-family and readable-body resolution; W1 text-spacing interpretation.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

08 / C04-C05: Hero boundary and media

C04 / Deferred creative work; required compatibility

Use a solid white header above the hero with no negative-margin overlap. Do not introduce scroll-dependent header polarity. Do not replace the hero asset, rewrite its copy, change its crop, alter its sequencing or introduce new playback, parallax or entrance effects. Capture its pre-change state. Isolate local hero foreground/background variables where global tokens would break readability. Preserve link destinations, overlays, mute/unmute and existing motion behavior. Record each compatibility edit and before/after evidence.

C05 / Product evidence before decoration

Use white frames for studio images with baked-in white backgrounds; reserve alabaster for suitable surrounding surfaces. Do not use multiply blending to change apparent product colors. Keep each image as a separate original asset. Do not produce or assemble collage, diptych, contact-sheet or other multi-panel files. Use a single primary image with separate thumbnails/gallery items. Retain at least two distinct approved photo styles per product. Do not fabricate a missing view, material, color, logo or construction detail.

SURFACE	PRESENTATION	DELIVERY / CHECK
Collection card	3:4 container; contain for isolated products, controlled cover for editorial images	Reserve dimensions. Verify no clipped hems, handles, eyewear temples or logos.
PDP gallery	Large primary frame, visible additional views, existing zoom controls	Preserve source ratio when needed; no mandatory crop that hides evidence.
Hover secondary view	Optional crossfade using existing alternate asset	Fine-pointer/hover devices only. All information available without hover.
Mobile gallery	Preserve existing gallery interaction and discovery controls	No compulsory gesture-only operation; swipe must coexist with page scrolling.
Image enhancement	Separate future asset work if approved and source quality warrants it	Retain originals and geometry; no claim that upscaling recovers missing detail.

Use Shopify responsive image delivery with realistic srcset/sizes, intrinsic dimensions and a suitable format. Load likely LCP media eagerly; lazy-load below-fold views. Avoid downloading desktop and mobile duplicates. Do not impose a universal 200KB cap at the expense of detail; compare bytes, visual quality and measured performance.

Basis: R1/R4 media; R2/R3 ergonomics; R5 performance proposals; S1 and G2 media prohibitions; W4 image delivery.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

09 / C06: Navigation and footer

Retain current navigation destinations and menu data. Simplify their visual treatment without removing discovery paths or inventing new merchandising taxonomy. Existing routes must remain reachable on keyboard, touch and pointer devices.

Header

• Use a solid white surface above the hero, with no overlap; keep this readable state when scrolled or drawers open. Center the existing wordmark where layout permits, with near-black icons and a restrained divider. Preserve search, account, currency/market and bag utilities when present.

• Keep product-aware tint subdued and contrast-safe. Treat translucent/blur styling as an enhancement with an opaque white fallback.

• Avoid stacking large announcement, header and sticky controls. Measure the actual header height for anchors and sticky PDP offsets; do not hardcode a competing z-index stack.

• Preserve mobile menu back controls, open/close actions, expanded states and focus restoration. Keep translated text and existing RTL support operable.

Search

Keep the existing predictive and full-results behavior, query persistence, result links, keyboard controls, loading and empty states. Restyle the drawer and results using the shared type/spacing system. Retain existing service links. New non-product indexing, three-layer suggestion systems and search routing changes are deferred unless separately approved after a confirmed gap.

Footer

Use a warm neutral, scannable footer with collection/house/service/legal groups. Preserve existing links and newsletter consent behavior. Verify direct paths to contact, fit guide, shipping, returns and privacy. Keep posted policy titles and destinations; do not promise a new return window or appointment service.

STATE	ACCEPTANCE
Closed / scrolled / product tint	Wordmark, icons and text remain visible on every surface.
Menu / search / bag open	One active modal focus boundary; Escape closes; focus returns to trigger.
320px / long labels / zoom	No offscreen utilities or horizontal page scroll; critical paths stay reachable.

Basis: R1/R4 navigation/footer; R5 discovery; R6-R7 restraint; G2-G3 product palette and policy preservation.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

10 / C07: Collection and product cards

Create a calm catalogue with the product as the main visual. The page begins with its existing collection name and concise context, followed by clear count, filters and sort controls. Reduce decorative chrome while keeping every working shopping action accessible.

AREA	PROPOSED IMPLEMENTATION	PASS CONDITION
Grid	Three columns >=1024px; two columns 375-1023px; one below 375px if needed	Names, prices and controls fit without clipping at 320px and zoom.
Card	3:4 media well; full product name and price/currency; essential availability	No invented badges, false scarcity, hidden sold-out state or misleading compare-at.
Alternate image	180-240ms opacity crossfade on capable devices	No hover-only action or repeated asset fetch; reduced motion removes nonessential animation.
Quick-shop / quick-add	Restyle existing feature and preserve current variant-selection flow	Keyboard and touch access remain; no blind add of an unselected variant.
Filters / sorting	Preserve data, URL behavior, counts, applied state and reset	Combined filters, back navigation, empty results and clear-all work as baseline.
Pagination / load more	Keep existing navigation and restoration behavior	No skipped or duplicate products; route/history remains correct.

No unapproved discovery redesign

Do not introduce or remove a column-density switcher just to match a research document. Keep the current control if present and functional; style it quietly. Do not add new filters based on inferred fabric or silhouette. Use verified existing product/category data and current platform filtering.

Editorial context

Retain useful collection copy and existing editorial links, with one clear focal point per module. Avoid adding narrative blocks between every product row. No collection reclassification, product suppression, price ladder or assortment edit is authorized by the visual transition.

Basis: R1/R4 grid proposals; R5 PLP details; R6-R7 discovery and editorial context. Conflicting quick-add/grid-toggle advice resolves in favor of function preservation.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

11 / C08: The canonical PDP contract

Presentation changes must follow the actual repository Bible. G3 defines the logical order below; technical implementation sections may contain several logical positions. Preserve helper sections and current bindings unless a separately reviewed change proves they are redundant.

ORDER	LOGICAL CONTENT	PRESERVATION RULE
01-06	Media; name; price; variants; purchase controls; Shipping & Returns	Readable identity and purchase path first. One canonical service message.
07-08	Story; category-required technical sections	Story: one paragraph, 2-4 sentences, target 35-80 words. No repeated specs or policy.
09	Complete the Set	Only a genuine custom.companion_product; preserve Selected piece / Matching piece clarity.
10	You might also like	custom.related_products first, else Shopify recommendations; up to four, exclude current product.
11	Recently viewed	Required section after recommendations; handle empty history without fabricated items.
12-13	Contextual merchandising; footer	Follow deterministic density, approved collections, fallback order and exclusions.

FAMILY	REQUIRED TECHNICAL DISCLOSURES	CONDITIONAL
Apparel	Material, Care, Fit	Construction; Complete the Set
Denim / footwear	Material, Care, Fit, Construction	Complete the Set
Bags	Material, Care	Construction; Use
Accessories	Material, Care	Construction; Fit; Use
Fragrance	Ingredients, Use	No apparel-specific panels unless genuinely applicable
Other	Applicable Material/Composition	Care, Fit, Construction, Use as applicable

Enrichment count includes Material, Care, Fit, Construction, Ingredients, Use and Complete the Set. Four or more: exactly one contextual module. Three or fewer: exactly two, subject to eligible available collection fallback. Maximum two. Do not activate disabled modules without checking duplication and canonical density.

Basis: G2 sections 5, 9-15; G3 pdpOrder/categoryMatrix/contextualMerchandising. Research seven-layer summaries are not substitutes.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

12 / C08: Presentation and state behavior

Purchase area

On a fitting desktop viewport, use an image-led split near 60/40 with a sticky purchase column that fits its available height. On smaller viewports, stack media and purchase controls. Keep price, currency, options, stock status and the primary action clear. Do not require the entire gallery to be scrolled before a shopper can select a size.

Use flat rectangular size cells, 48px targets, clear selected styling and a nearby size-guide link. Keep unavailable variants visible and disabled. A black primary button with white text is the default visual treatment. Preserve existing accessible action labels and cart event contracts; do not rename transactional strings as a cosmetic shortcut.

STATE	EXPECTED BEHAVIOR
Available / selected	Variant ID, price, media, availability and sticky CTA remain synchronized.
Unavailable combination / sold out	Clear text state; no enabled purchase control; no hidden unavailable sizes. No new reservation path.
Adding / success / failure	Prevent duplicate submissions; announce result; keep retry possible after a real failure. No animation-gated input.
Mobile sticky CTA	Preserve existing visibility logic. Safe-area inset and page padding prevent obscured content; hide/adjust for open drawers and keyboard.
Technical disclosures	Hairline rows retain canonical names and content. Native disclosure or current accessible behavior; no merged Material/Care panel that loses section ownership.
Companion / recommendations	Respect canonical product references and labels; preserve existing individual/set purchase behavior and stock constraints.

Evidence-backed content stays

Keep names, diacritics, specs, model measurements and material claims exactly as verified. Do not add provenance, garment weights or factory details from illustrative research examples. Fit guidance remains in Fit; composition in Material; care actions in Care; construction in Construction. Style empty states rather than filling missing facts with AI copy.

Basis: R1/R4 buy-box/disclosures; R5 mobile controls; R7 editorial PDP; G2-G3 semantics and availability.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

13 / C09-C10: Response, service and bag

C09 / Motion and component language

Use 160-220ms control feedback, 180-240ms image fades and 240-320ms drawer transitions with gentle ease-out. Input responds immediately. Restrict animation to opacity/transform where possible; do not add motion libraries, scroll hijacking, custom cursors, decorative loaders, or hidden-on-load content. Reduced motion removes nonessential movement and palette rotation.

Lookbook markers require a contrasting core and outer ring on both dark and light images. Keep a 24px visual marker inside a minimum 44px interactive target. Favor square corners for media, cards and primary controls. Use coherent currentColor SVG icons around 1.5px stroke, with explicit accessible labels. Retain native payment marks, browser controls and product geometry. A 2px high-contrast focus outline with 3px offset is the project target; verify it remains visible on all surfaces.

C10 / Existing service, presented clearly

Restyle current contact, concierge, appointment and newsletter surfaces. Keep only channels and service hours supported by current store data. Do not add VIP status, manufacturing heritage, premium packaging, WhatsApp numbers, live advisors, gifting options or response promises from benchmark-house examples.

Shopping bag and quick-shop

Use a white drawer, legible item title/variant/quantity/price, restrained separators and a prominent checkout area. Preserve add, remove, quantity updates, discounts, cart attributes, totals, stock errors, locale/currency and enabled payment integrations. Do not alter payment-provider branding or checkout behavior.

BAG SCENARIO	ACCEPTANCE
Empty / populated / long cart	Correct copy and totals; independently scrollable items; checkout reachable.
Quantity / remove / stock error	One mutation per intended action; totals and bag count update; errors announced.
Menu / bag / quick-shop lifecycle	No competing focus traps or scroll locks; close returns focus to correct trigger.
Delivery / returns	Use current canonical policy. No spending threshold, invented express upgrade or duplicate PDP trust strip.

Basis: R2/R3/R5/R7 motion and cart; R6 system consistency; G2 duplicate-claim and policy rules. Slow 600ms orchestration and new services are rejected.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

14 / Verified engineering targets

Read-only inspection anchor: main tree 012a73fcca2e63e04e5a7c8e1e4afe8c9e45d3f9. Re-resolve current main and the published Shopify theme before Phase 4. Repository source is not proof of the currently published theme or current product data.

VERIFIED PATH / GROUP	ROLE AND REQUIRED ACTION
templates/product.json	Default main_product uses melato-product-page-rebuild. Dark colors are saved in its section settings. Do not target main-product.liquid by assumption. Inspect every alternate product template.
sections/melato-product-page-rebuild.liquid	Contains inline styles, local palette seeds, variant and sticky-CTA logic. Separate white canvas from announcement seed without changing canonical fields.
assets/melato-house-pdp.css; melato-house.css	Current house layer has dark PDP tokens and global type/header rules. Refactor active token consumers and remove competing dark rules.
assets/melato-palette-v3.css; layout/theme.liquid	Palette overrides use !important and light icon assets; layout loads multiple layers. Trace cascade and embedded SVG colors, not only root variables.
sections/melato-header.liquid; melato-main-search.liquid; snippets/search-drawer.liquid	Style current navigation/search; preserve settings, links and event bindings.
sections/main-collection.liquid; assets/melato-house-collection.css; melato-collection-filters.js	Style cards/filter presentation without replacing current discovery behavior.
snippets/cart-drawer.liquid; assets/melato-cart-drawer.js; melato-complete-set.js	Preserve cart and pairing behavior. Identify active quick-shop renderer from actual include graph.
sections/related-products.liquid; recently-viewed.liquid; melato-pdp-contextual-merchandising.liquid	Keep canonical ordering and deduplication. Default contextual section is disabled: investigate runtime renderer before activation.

A new assets/melato-luxury-tokens.css may be proposed in Phase 4; it is not an existing verified file. Configure one source of truth rather than another override pile. Root package.json includes a separate Next/React lookbook app: its build does not validate Liquid theme rendering.

Basis: G4 repository tree, default template, layout, house CSS, rebuild section and package.json, read October 22, 2026.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

15 / Cascade, settings and automation risks

RISK-01 / CI can write directly to main

The current melato-product-page-bible-guard.yml grants contents: write and, on push to main, runs repair code, commits changes, and pushes HEAD:main. Its string-based repair logic includes the old dark trust-strip styling. This can fail on changed literals or, where matching legacy input exists, restore the old treatment.

Phase 4 must propose a reviewed workflow change that makes the relevant repair path validation-only, with read-only permissions where possible. Remove automatic main mutation from that path while preserving Bible validation. Inspect every workflow for equivalent writes before integration. This is a prerequisite to satisfying the owner’s no-direct-main rule; no workflow was changed in Phase 2.

RISK-02 / Existing settings beat new defaults

Changing settings_schema defaults will not necessarily replace saved values in settings_data or template section settings. Inventory active color schemes, alternate PDP templates and merchant settings. Migrate only the documented visual settings. Preserve app blocks, section IDs, content, contact settings and layout configuration. Keep a settings diff and rollback snapshot.

RISK-03 / Multiple palette and repair consumers

Inventory active palette scripts, safe-accent helper sections, header tint rules and runtime patchers before changing them. One engine must own palette state and derived contrast values. Refactor obsolete rules through their owners; do not fix every symptom with higher specificity or broad !important selectors.

RISK-04 / Source and published theme may differ

At Phase 4 entry, read the published theme ID/name, export its current bytes/settings and compare to the repository baseline. Reconcile divergence on the development branch. No historical ZIP or claimed theme ID is accepted as current production evidence.

RISK-05 / Tests can encode the old appearance

Separate semantic assertions from legacy pixel/hex expectations. Preserve semantic requirements, update only obsolete visual assertions with rationale, and run the canonical validator directly as well as CI. Green tests against an unused template do not establish success.

Basis: G1-G4; verified workflow SHA 0a531957030f6bc07ca98c37474b81f670d2278f. Risk assessment is an implementation inference from inspected source.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

16 / Phase 4 implementation work packages

PACKAGE / DEPENDENCY	WORK / REVIEWABLE OUTPUT	EXIT EVIDENCE
WP0 / finalized Phase 3 docs	Re-read governance; verify main and live theme; export settings; create feat/melato-luxury-transition. Capture baseline routes, interactions and screenshots.	Base commit; theme ID; source diff; page/state inventory; rollback snapshot.
WP1 / WP0	Propose validation-only workflow repair; inventory cascade and font loads; define semantic tokens; map aliases and safe palette ownership.	Workflow diff; token map; no automatic main writes in affected release path; hero boundary recorded.
WP2 / WP1	Implement C01-C03 and saved visual settings; remove redundant fonts/overrides after consumer audit.	Computed-style snapshots at all widths and dynamic accent states; settings diff.
WP3 / WP2	Implement C05-C07: media framing, navigation/footer, collection cards and filter styling.	Route parity; separate media assets; collection/search/menu regression results.
WP4 / WP3	Implement C08 and C10: active PDP renderer, disclosures, sets, recommendations, bag and existing service surfaces.	Category/state matrix; canonical validator; cart/quick-shop and checkout-handoff evidence.
WP5 / WP4	Apply C09 consistently; hero compatibility only; check mobile, RTL/locales and reduced motion.	Motion/focus evidence; keyboard and viewport QA; scoped hero diff.
WP6 / all	Run full agreed checks on the candidate SHA and unpublished theme. Resolve findings and prepare PR.	Evidence bundle; candidate SHA/theme hash; remaining issues; exact release recommendation.

Use small reversible commits tied to category IDs. Each package includes its affected checks; the final package verifies the combined system. Existing library or slider rewrites are excluded unless needed to resolve a reproduced blocker within approved scope. Do not promise sprint dates before baseline inspection establishes actual effort.

The owner has now authorized the revised decision lock and the start of dedicated-branch development. Merge, publication and unrelated system changes remain outside this instruction.

Basis: Owner phase contract; G1 operator governance; R1-R7 sequencing consolidated around the active theme.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

17 / Functional validation and evidence

All checks below are planned for Phase 4. No storefront tests or implementation checks are claimed to have passed in Phase 2. Run on a documented candidate SHA and unpublished Shopify theme using representative existing products selected from fresh store data.

TEST SET	REQUIRED COVERAGE / EVIDENCE
Static / canonical	Shopify Theme Check; template/config JSON or JSONC-aware parsing; section schemas; node scripts/validate-melato-product-page-bible.mjs; applicable repository guards; npm test. Record commands, exit codes and complete failures.
Discovery	Home -> collection -> PDP; search query/results/empty state; filter combinations, reset, sorting, pagination/load-more and browser Back. Existing quick-shop works on touch and keyboard.
PDP / variants	Available, unavailable and sold-out combinations; variant-specific media/price/currency; size guide; technical disclosures; sticky action sync; no duplicate add.
Categories	Apparel, denim, footwear, bag, accessory, fragrance and Other where active examples exist. Include one true set, one standalone product, missing optional data and a long product name.
Merchandising	Companion relationship, current-product exclusion, recommendations and recently viewed ordering; contextual density and fallback; duplicate-content checks.
Cart / checkout handoff	Empty/populated/long cart; add/remove/quantity; network and stock error; discounts/attributes where supported; totals, bag count and enabled checkout/payment entry points. No real paid order required.
Lifecycle	Menu, search, gallery zoom, size guide, quick-shop and bag: focus entry/exit, Escape, scroll-lock cleanup and no conflicting overlays.
Data preservation	Before/after comparison of sampled titles, prices, variant IDs, specs, policy copy, canonical field usage, URLs and enabled integrations. Visual work must not mutate catalogue data.

Store evidence outside the public theme payload. For each failure: expected/actual result, route, viewport, product/variant ID, candidate SHA and reproducible steps. Keep customer/session data out of screenshots and committed artifacts.

Basis: G2-G3 canonical requirements; G4 package/test scripts and guards; R7 regression rubric.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

18 / Visual, accessibility and performance gates

GATE	PASS CRITERIA / METHOD
Visual coverage	320, 390, 768, 1024, 1440 and 1920px widths. Homepage, collection, category PDPs, search, menu, bag, footer and editorial/lookbook. Check long names and saved settings. Capture matched baseline/candidate screenshots.
Typography / surfaces	Exactly two production font families outside documented deferred-hero compatibility exceptions. White commerce canvas; intended neutral wells; full text; no dark overrides or white-on-white icons. Verify computed styles, not source hex searches alone.
Contrast	Text >=4.5:1, large text >=3:1; required control boundaries and state indicators >=3:1. Check real composited backgrounds, dynamic palette transitions, hover, focus and selected states. No blanket AAA claim.
Keyboard / touch	Full keyboard path and visible focus; no obscured focus or trapped state. Project targets >=44px controls and 48px size cells. Touch paths do not depend on hover.
Reflow / text spacing	200% zoom and 320px reflow without content loss. Override line-height 1.5, paragraph spacing 2em, letter-spacing .12em and word-spacing .16em together; no clipped text or unusable controls.
Motion / screen reader	Reduced-motion disables nonessential transitions and palette cycling. Accessible labels, errors, expanded states and cart feedback checked manually plus automated scan. No new critical/serious automated violations; scan is not full conformance proof.
Performance	Compare median of 3 matched mobile lab runs per home/collection/PDP. Proposed budget: Lighthouse performance drop <=5 points and LCP slowdown <=10% vs baseline; CLS <=0.1. Investigate any failure before release.

Field targets after release: LCP <=2.5s, INP <=200ms and CLS <=0.1 at the 75th percentile. These are monitoring targets, not a pre-release lab certification. Preserve a known poor baseline only by documented owner-accepted exception, never by calling it a pass. Existing unrelated blockers need explicit disposition before release.

Basis: R2/R5/R7 validation proposals; W1-W4. Numeric lab regression budgets are proposed project limits, not external standards.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

19 / Phase 3 automated peer-review contract

Peer-review comments have been received and dispositioned in the appended decision lock. The owner has authorized revision, lock and the start of development. Unimplemented storefront behavior must not be described as tested. Each finding must cite a category or requirement, identify evidence, state impact, and propose a concrete correction.

REVIEW ID	REQUIRED QUESTION / PASS CONDITION
PR-SCOPE	Exactly ten categories; C04 creative work deferred; all six added enhancements traced; no new commercial workflows.
PR-CANON	Names, section order, category disclosures, canonical fields, policy and product palette match G2-G3. No research example becomes product data.
PR-DESIGN	One palette/type/spacing/component system; readable mobile rules; all proposed constants identified as decisions.
PR-EVIDENCE	Supplied research separated from current repository facts, inferences and future checks. Unsupported commercial lift and official-font claims excluded.
PR-IMPLEMENT	Active renderer and alternate templates covered; saved settings, CSS load order and runtime patchers addressed; no headless rebuild.
PR-GIT	Dedicated development branch and reviewed PR; direct main writes, including relevant automation, addressed.
PR-VERIFY	Functional, visual, accessibility and performance tests have explicit pass criteria and evidence. Lab/field distinction is clear.
PR-RELEASE	Finalized-document handoff precedes coding; publishing is separate from merging; candidate identity, backup, rollback and monitoring specified.

Finding format and resolution

ID | severity | PDF page/category | source/requirement | observed conflict | required change | verification | disposition. Severity: Blocker = unsafe or impossible execution; Major = missing required behavior or acceptance test; Minor = limited ambiguity; Editorial = presentation only.

Phase 3 exit: zero unresolved Blocker or Major findings; minor findings resolved or explicitly accepted with rationale; a consolidated change log; owner-provided final documentation version. Preserve stable category IDs and record which version supersedes this PDF. The current owner instruction authorizes the documented development scope; it does not authorize merge or publication.

Basis: Owner Phase 3 workflow; R6-R7 review checklists; G1-G3 governance.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

20 / Phase 5 release and rollback

Before merge

Require the reviewed PR, zero unresolved blocking findings, passing required checks on the current candidate, and the evidence bundle tied to its SHA. Confirm no further changes after validation. Re-read current repository governance and obtain the owner’s specific merge/release authorization at the required gate.

Before storefront publication

• Capture current published theme ID, theme files, saved settings and a timestamped backup. Keep the previous working theme available for immediate republish.

• Verify the repository-to-Shopify deployment method and its automatic publish behavior. Merging must not silently publish an unreviewed candidate.

• Upload to an unpublished theme and confirm the deployed content corresponds to the approved SHA, including merchant settings and app blocks.

• Perform final smoke checks for home, collection, representative PDP, variants, cart and checkout handoff. Use test/sandbox mechanisms for payment checks; no unauthorized real transaction.

• Publish only the approved candidate. Record old/new theme IDs, release SHA, approval, time and operator.

Rollback triggers and action

Rollback immediately for broken add-to-cart/checkout handoff, widespread missing prices/variants, inaccessible navigation, unreadable critical controls, or major storefront rendering failure. Republish the prior verified theme and restore its matching settings as needed. Verify product -> cart -> checkout handoff, then isolate the candidate failure on the development branch. Do not repair production by direct main commits.

Post-release verification

Repeat critical route/state smoke checks against the live theme. Inspect console/cart errors and compare available performance and funnel signals against the baseline. Field Core Web Vitals require sufficient real-user data; do not declare an uplift or stability result from a short observation window. Retain rollback until the release is accepted and stable.

Done means the approved visual scope is implemented, verified on its exact candidate, published only after the proper gate, and recoverable. It does not mean every historical product-data issue or the future hero redesign is solved.

Basis: Owner Phase 5 contract; G1 governance; R1-R7 validation/release concepts consolidated.

PHASE 3 / REVIEW DISPOSITION

21 / Owner-authorized decision lock / R-01-R-08

On October 23, 2026, TheHighBrid instructed: revise, lock the decisions and start execution. This authorizes the revised specification and dedicated-branch development. It does not authorize merge, publication or a paid transaction. The external review page numbers did not match the delivered 22-page v1.0 PDF; the substantive findings are resolved below by stable requirement ID.

ID	LOCKED DISPOSITION
R-01	Repository Bible, JSON contract and executable validator govern. Preserve canonical order, labels and concise Story. Recheck current approved contracts before product-policy work.
R-02	Cormorant Garamond 400 for editorial headings >=28px; Plus Jakarta Sans 400/500 for UI and body. Utility sans owns commerce numbers with lining/tabular numerals.
R-03	main 012a73fcca2e63e04e5a7c8e1e4afe8c9e45d3f9; published gelato-v1-00, theme ID 167790772479. Reconcile live differences before activating redesigned templates.
R-04	Three desktop columns >=1024px; two at 375-1023px; one below 375px where needed. Preserve existing density controls. Reject an automatic four-column wide-desktop switch.
R-05	Solid white header above hero, no negative-margin overlap. Readable dark ink/icons when top, scrolled and drawer-open. No new scroll-driven polarity behavior.
R-06	Existing canonical contact/service destinations only. No new staffed channels or appointment/WhatsApp promises.
R-07	Preserve category-conditional rendering. Current repo says fragrance Ingredients/Use. Reconcile any later approved fragrance standard before changing its policy/data; foundation batch makes no fragrance edits.
R-08	Preserve canonical delivery/returns policy and verified current category exceptions. No new shipping threshold or express-delivery claim.

Technical conditions incorporated

White studio frames without multiply blending; contextual hardcoded-color and embedded-SVG audit with legitimate exceptions; dual-contrast hotspots with 24px visuals and >=44px hit targets; numeric styling; and validation-only CI without automatic main commits. These revise the proposed solutions without weakening the original preservation rules.

Basis: Owner instruction and supplied review in this conversation; current read-only repository and Shopify theme checks October 23, 2026.

PHASE 4 / FIRST IMPLEMENTATION BATCH

22 / W0 evidence and W1 execution status

Development branch: feat/melato-luxury-transition. Main remains at the recorded baseline. Live theme metadata and 270 text files were read without store mutations. Comparison found 220 identical files, 38 differing files and 12 live-only files. The snapshot is limited to code/config/locales; it is not a complete binary-media theme backup.

AREA	VERIFIED STATE / NEXT REQUIREMENT
Source reconciliation	Differences include layout, saved settings, templates, cart and the product color engine. Review each active renderer before activation. Do not overwrite live-only fixes or merchant settings with repository defaults.
Inherited test state	Before changes: canonical Bible validator passes. npm test: 44 tests, 36 pass, 8 fail. Failures involve existing copy/metadata, lookbook, duplicate surfaces, reviews, currency and hero audio assertions.
Initial implementation	Semantic token asset; numeral utility; contextual color audit; decision lock; read-only Bible workflow replacing automatic repair/commit/push behavior. No storefront inclusion of the new token stylesheet yet.
Activation boundary	The token asset is not a fourth corrective stylesheet. Existing CSS owners will migrate to these tokens after live reconciliation. No layout/template, product data or production setting has been changed in the foundation batch.
Validation scope	Audit-tool behavior and canonical validation can be checked now. Browser visual, computed-style, accessibility, performance and full commerce gates remain pending on an integrated unpublished candidate.

W0 completion is bounded

Repository/theme identities, text snapshot and inherited failures are recorded. Full visual baseline and complete rollback export are still required before integrated-theme activation or deployment. No development or live Shopify theme was written during this first batch. A draft PR is a progress artifact, not a passing release candidate.

Basis: Read-only Shopify theme query, paginated files export and exact local baseline tests on October 23, 2026.

LOCKED SPECIFICATION / DEVELOPMENT

23 / Traceability and review handoff

CATEGORIES	RESEARCH SUPPORT	CANONICAL GUARDRAIL
C01-C03	R1/R4 detailed foundations; R2/R3/R5 type and rhythm; R6/R7 readability	G2-G3 product colors; two-family resolution; saved settings verified in Phase 4.
C04-C05	R1/R4 isolation/media; R2/R3 media and mobile; R5/R7 delivery	Owner hero deferral; G2 separate files and truthful imagery.
C06-C07	R1/R4 navigation/grids; R5 search/PLP; R6/R7 discovery	Current links, menus, filters, quick-shop and catalogue facts preserved.
C08	R1/R4 purchase and craft; R5 split PDP; R6 narrative; R7 hierarchy	G2-G3 order, category matrix, canonical fields, labels and density.
C09-C10	R2/R3 motion; R5 bag/service; R6 consistency; R7 service	No new service promises or commercial rules; W1-W4 safety/performance checks.

Source locations

R1-R7: supplied Melato High Fashion Transition.zip / Primary Reseach Supporting Documents / Melato Luxury Web Transition Research by [Argon (1)-(5), PERPLE(1), SOL (0)]. R4 is the Markdown file; the others are PDFs. S1 and S2 are the attached Product Page Bible and Product Naming Style PDFs. S3/S4 are historical files within Secondary Optional Supporting Documents.

G1-G4: https://github.com/TheHighBrid/Gelato at main tree 012a73fcca2e63e04e5a7c8e1e4afe8c9e45d3f9. G1 governance; G2 docs/MELATO_PRODUCT_PAGE_BIBLE.md; G3 config/melato-product-page-bible.json; G4 inspected paths on pages 15-16. Repository reads establish source state, not deployment state.

W1: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/text-spacing.html
W2: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/target-size-minimum.html
W3: https://web.dev/articles/defining-core-web-vitals-thresholds
W4: https://shopify.dev/docs/storefronts/themes/best-practices/performance
Technical references checked October 22, 2026.

Evidence limits and the next action

No live Shopify audit, new competitor teardown, implementation, branch creation, merge or publication occurred in Phase 2. Historical assertions, scanned ancillary material, external Google Drive links and claimed business outcomes were not promoted to verified facts. The blueprint specifies future live-theme reconciliation and tests rather than implying they already passed.

Next action: reconcile the documented live-theme differences on the isolated development branch, then activate and validate the approved foundations. This version supersedes v1.0 design choices as recorded in the appended owner-authorized decision lock.